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Many at MIT urge school to resist compact

Say ‘no amount of money is worth’ what White House is demanding of colleges

By Diti Kohli, Brooke Hauser, and Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

The new conditions for federal funding the Trump administration offered to MIT put the school in a no-win situation, people on the Cambridge campus and throughout academia said Friday: Agree to the federal government’s terms and surrender some academic freedom, or refuse and risk further punishment.

The White House’s proposed “Compact for Academic Excellence in Higher Education” — sent to MIT and eight other top-tier universities this week — ties access to federal money to a string of conditions that, if agreed to, would effectuate the most substantial changes MIT has seen to date and fundamentally transform an economic powerhouse of Greater Boston.

The 10-point document asks the

list of schools — which also includes Brown and Dartmouth — to cap international student enrollment, freeze domestic tuition rates for five years, and commit to strict defini-

►When the Trump administration went after universities, Duke made for an odd target. **A2.**

tions of gender. Some of those requests, such as reducing tuition and the number of international students, are popular with many Americans. But others, including one to limit the speech of university em-

ployees, strike at the heart of freedom and independence that universities have long prized.

While MIT declined to comment, on campus and in academia, there doesn’t appear to be much inclination to make a deal with the White House.

The offer amounts to “a loyalty oath to the federal government,” said Catherine D’Ignazio, an MIT professor of urban studies and planning.

“They’re asking us to sacrifice science. They’re asking us to sacri-

MIT, Page A6

Hamas ready to release hostages

But cites conditions still to be met in proposal

By Liam Stack
NEW YORK TIMES

TEL AVIV — Hamas said Friday that it was ready to release its remaining Israeli hostages as part of an American-proposed cease-fire plan, a potential breakthrough two years after the group led the attack that set off the war in the Gaza Strip.

But the militant group made clear it wanted to negotiate other elements of the plan proposed by President Trump this week, leaving open the question of whether its offer would satisfy Israel.

Trump said on social media Friday evening that he believed the group was “ready for a lasting PEACE,” and he demanded that Israel “immediately stop the bombing of Gaza.”

The Israeli government did not immediately make a public statement. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu of Israel had already agreed to the American-backed 20-point proposal, but it was not clear late Friday, the Sabbath in Israel, how he would react to Hamas’s response.

GAZA, Page A3

SPOOKY SEASON UNDERWAY



BEN PENNINGTON FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Costumed paraders marched down Essex Street on Thursday night as attendees of all ages lined the streets of downtown Salem during the Salem Haunted Happenings Grand Parade, the start of a month of Halloween celebrations.

‘I’m 90 years old. I’m thinking about the future, my grandchildren.’

ANNETTE MANASSE, on why she protests

Seniors demonstrate against Trump’s actions

For some, it’s a new direction; but for others, it’s just the latest fight

By Jessica Ma
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Annette Manasse, 90, trekked half a mile down a Brookline street past buzzing cars and storefronts splashed with color. With a cane in hand and a sturdy pair of sneakers on her feet, she was set on reaching her destination: a protest.

The old-timer has made this pilgrimage every Saturday afternoon for the past few months. She walked slowly — but surely. There were benches along the way, in case she got tired.

Soon enough, she was standing on the side of the busy intersection at Coolidge Corner — her sparkly red nails gripping a poster that read “First Amendment Rights.” Amid the hum of trains and honking of cars, she protested beside about 50 other seniors, who are dissatisfied with the Trump administration, on a recent Saturday.

“I’m 90 years old. I’m thinking about the future, my grandchildren, and any potential great-grandchildren,” Manasse said. “I’m wondering: What kind of world are we bringing these children into?”

The group, most of whom met at a senior residence, call their gatherings “Rally for Democracy.” Seniors coming out to protest isn’t just limited to Brookline. Across the country, older Americans are rallying against the federal government, reshaping an activity that people tend to associate with the youth. Many are grandparents who see organizing as a way to secure a better future for their children. Some protested the Vietnam War in the 1960s, while others are partaking in civil disobedience for the first time.

The turnout is striking for an age range that tends to lean conservative. For registered voters ages 60 to

SENIORS, Page A10

Flooded out again, Vt. community waits to see if help is coming

By Julian E.J. Sorapuru
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — On July 10 for each of the last three years, Sutton, Vt., was overwhelmed by floods.

After the first two storms, the rural farm town of roughly 1,000 received \$1.1 million in disaster aid from the federal government to repair streets, install culverts, and pay contractors. It is hoping for similar help after this year’s flood, which inundated roads, ruined basements, and washed out bridges.

So far, Sutton has borrowed about \$1 million for repair work while it awaits the outcome of Vermont’s request for President Trump to declare a major disaster in the state from the July 10 flooding, which would free up federal funding. But with Trump repeatedly saying he wants the federal government to be less involved in disaster relief — even suggesting dismantling the Federal Emergency Management Agency altogether —

Sutton residents are in limbo, anxious that they might be on their own this time.

The uncertainty is “a little bit scary for the town,” said Patti McClure, the town clerk and treasurer. “It really comes down to, if we don’t get the [federal] funds of any sort, that is going to be a huge loan that’ll go on the taxpayers.”

It is a difficult time for states and communities seeking help from the US government, as Trump wants to reduce their reliance on such aid and also cut down on federal spending. FEMA has already denied assistance for winter storms in Kentucky, cyclones in Washington, and flooding in Tennessee and Maryland.

However, the White House reportedly has softened its stance on FEMA after devastating flash floods in Central Texas killed more than 100 people, The Washington Post reported in July. A review council appointed by the White House is expected to

FEMA, Page A10

Shutdown’s tone has no precedent

By Erica L. Green
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — When President Bill Clinton’s staff relegated Speaker Newt Gingrich to the back of Air Force One on an international trip, it went down in history as an epic taunt that triggered a government shutdown.

►Rep. Ayanna Pressley hosts shutdown talk with laborers, politicians, employers. **B1.**

Gingrich was fuming after the long flight from Israel, during which the two never got to discuss their budget impasse, and after which he was made to deplane down the back stairs. His admission that the snub factored into his decision to shut down the government in 1995 earned him a cover of The Daily News, which depicted him as a diaper-clad toddler throwing a tantrum with the blaring headline “CRY BABY.”

The episode was considered one of the most enduring illustrations of just how ugly government shutdowns can get. Until now.

During the first government shutdown in near-

SHUTDOWN, Page A7

WOMAN TO LEAD CHURCH OF ENGLAND



BEN STANSALL/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Bishop Sarah Mullally, seen in the Corona Chapel at Canterbury Cathedral, was named as the next archbishop of Canterbury, a first for a woman. **A4.**

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Fall’s advertising

Saturday: Sunny and warm. High: 79-84. Low: 57-62.

Sunday: Sunny and warm. High: 74-79. Low: 58-63.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

Sean “Diddy” Combs was sentenced to four years and two months in prison for transporting people across state lines for sexual encounters. **A2.**

The US military killed four men aboard a boat in international waters near Venezuela, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said. **A4.**

Eric Sweeney, a 19-year-old who killed his sister-in-law and two young nephews three years ago, was sentenced to 60 years to life in prison for each of the three murders. **B1.**

Yankees pitcher Cam Schittler’s motivation came straight from his own buddies, writes Tara Sullivan. **C1.**